FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE
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PEJ 2011 Raw Data Sets Now Available Online

Monday, July 2—The Pew Research Center's Project for Excellence in Journalism is pleased to release the 2011 News Coverage Index raw data set and toplines of additional reports. The data are now available for scholars to use in their research and can be downloaded on PEJ's website at **http://www.journalism.org/by_the_numbers/datasets**

The News Coverage Index (NCI)—The NCI captures and analyzes 52 news outlets in real time to determine what is being covered and what is not in the U.S. news media. The analysis is conducted weekly, Monday - Sunday. The key variables include source, story date, big story, broad story topic, placement, format, geographic focus, story word count, duration of broadcast story and lead newsmaker. The outlets studied come from print, network TV, cable, online, and radio. They include evening and morning network news, several hours of daytime and prime time cable news each day, newspapers from around the country, the top online news sites, and radio, including headlines, long form programs and talk.

Additional reports—PEJ offers topline data for additional reports. The focus of these opportunistic studies ranged from how the mainstream media outlets use twitter to the tone of campaign news coverage.

The 2011 NCI data set totals 48,555 stories: 5,190 newspaper stories, 7,744 online stories, 11,858 stories from network television, 15,324 stories on cable news, and 8,439 stories from radio programs. The data set is offered in SPSS through the use of zip files and is accompanied by the coding scheme and other explanatory material. In addition, toplines from additional studies are included as PDF files. PEJ makes data sets of the Index available on a yearly basis. The 2007 data set was released in July 2008; the 2008 data set was released in July 2009; the 2009 data set was released in July 2010 and the 2010 data set was released in July 2011.

The News Coverage Index was designed by PEJ Director Tom Rosenstiel and Deputy Director Amy Mitchell and an advisory team of nine academic and commercial researchers, including Steve Lacy of the Michigan State University, Esther Thorson of the University of Missouri—Columbia and Dan Riffe of University of North Carolina—Chapel Hill. It required the creation of proprietary software and a new website. The coding team of sixteen professionals works 24 hours behind the news cycle. They work with Senior Researcher, Paul Hitlin, Supervising Research Methodologist, Hong Ji, Weekly News Index Manager Tricia Sartor and Research Analyst Laura Santhanam.

PEJ, which is non-partisan and non-political, is one of seven projects that make up the Pew Research Center in Washington, D.C., a "fact tank" funded by the Pew Charitable Trusts.

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